

Composition Pair 1: Minimum Viable Governance and Time-Sensitive Coordination

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This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in “Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration” (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026) and “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

Two operational commitments in the CKS architecture — the Minimum Viable Governance Floor (D2.37), which specifies seven irreducible requirements for a compliant Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event, and Time-Sensitive Governance (D2.41), which provides mechanisms for rapid FAI participation — appear to stand in tension: an event that must begin within hours cannot afford the configuration authoring time the floor seemingly requires. This note formalizes the composition pair D2.37 + D2.41 and shows that the apparent tension resolves entirely through pre-authorization. The floor requirements do not need to be satisfied in real-time during the event; they need to be in place when the event begins. A standing governance configuration jointly authorized before urgency arises satisfies the floor and enables rapid execution simultaneously. Three non-obvious requirements follow from this resolution: pre-authorization is a mandatory precondition for the composition pair, not an optional optimization; the floor becomes the maximum governance a time-sensitive event can realistically absorb, not merely the minimum; and the composition pair forecloses an adversarial claim that governed rapid FAI coordination is novel, because the architecture anticipated and resolved the apparent tension.

1. Pair Identification

Commitment A — Minimum Viable Governance Floor (D2.37). Seven requirements constitute a compliant FAI event. The floor is irreducible: an event that fails to satisfy all seven is not a governed FAI event within the CKS architecture. The requirements, stated at their minimum, are: (1) a standing or authored configuration specifying event parameters; (2) joint authorization of the configuration across participating governance structures; (3) defined sharing scope — which aspects each Self contributes; (4) human-authored orchestration rules covering conflict handling at the inter-Self perimeter; (5) a specified persistence policy governing what remains after dissolution

and where; (6) auditability by inheritance from the shared substrate's substrate-content commitments; and (7) available human authority — the right to inspect, modify, and override the shared substrate at any time during the event. The floor is the minimum governance architecture that preserves the CKS commitments established in Papers 1 and 2 at the inter-Self scope.

Commitment B — Time-Sensitive Governance (D2.41). Certain operational needs require FAI participation to begin within hours or less — within a timeframe that does not permit standard pre-event configuration authoring. Time-sensitive governance provides the mechanisms by which rapid FAI participation is possible within the CKS architecture: standing configurations (D2.21), pre-authorized orchestration rules, and governance infrastructure built before urgency arises. These mechanisms allow the latency between decision and event initiation to approach zero, subject to the constraint that compliant operation is maintained.

The composition pair asks: what are the governance requirements that emerge when both commitments must be satisfied simultaneously — when an event must be rapid and must also meet the seven-requirement floor?

2. The Governance Scenario Requiring Both Simultaneously

An inter-Self coordination need arises. The operational situation requires an FAI event to begin within hours — there is no runway for deliberation, configuration authoring, or joint authorization negotiation. Standard governance preparation time is unavailable. If time-sensitive governance (D2.41) alone governed, the event could proceed rapidly; if it satisfied the floor (D2.37) in the way routine events do — by authoring a configuration at the time of need — it could not proceed rapidly. The scenario forces the question: what infrastructure must exist beforehand if rapid AND compliant operation is to be possible?

This is not an exotic or marginal scenario. Operational AI coordination increasingly involves response to fast-moving circumstances. Any deployment of the CKS architecture at inter-Self scope must account for the possibility of time-sensitive FAI events. The composition pair formalizes what the architecture requires of practitioners who plan to operate in this mode.

3. Governance Requirements from the Combination

Three requirements emerge from the composition of D2.37 and D2.41 that are not apparent from either commitment considered alone.

Non-Obvious Requirement 1 — Floor Satisfaction Through Pre-Authorization

The apparent tension between the floor and rapid execution dissolves when the temporal structure of compliance is examined precisely. The seven minimum viable governance floor requirements do not need to be satisfied *in real-time during* the FAI event; they need to be *in place when the event begins*. This distinction is architecturally decisive.

A standing configuration (D2.21) that was jointly authorized before urgency arose satisfies Requirement 1 (authored configuration) and Requirement 2 (joint authorization) of the floor.

Pre-authorized orchestration rules covering conflict handling at the inter-Self perimeter satisfy Requirement 4. Sharing scope, persistence policy, and auditability commitments, similarly encoded in the standing configuration, satisfy Requirements 3, 5, and 6. Available human authority (Requirement 7) is a property of the governance architecture, not of per-event authoring, and holds continuously. When all seven floor requirements are encoded in pre-authorized standing infrastructure, the floor is met the moment the event begins — with no real-time governance authoring required.

Pre-authorization is therefore the mechanism that makes the floor and rapid execution compatible. Neither commitment sacrifices the other; the composition pair is satisfiable, but only through this mechanism.

Non-Obvious Requirement 2 — Pre-Authorization as Mandatory Floor Precondition

Because the composition pair is satisfiable only through pre-authorization, the absence of pre-authorization infrastructure means the pair cannot be satisfied simultaneously. If no standing configuration exists and no orchestration rules have been pre-authorized, a practitioner facing a time-sensitive need faces a forced choice: take the time required to meet the floor (authoring the configuration, obtaining joint authorization, encoding the rules), or proceed without meeting the floor. Neither option satisfies both commitments. A time-sensitive event that skips the floor to achieve speed is not governed rapid FAI coordination within the CKS architecture; it is ungoverned rapid coordination that trades compliance for speed.

This makes pre-authorization infrastructure a mandatory precondition, not an optimization. Practitioners who build standing governance infrastructure before urgency arises are not doing optional preparation work — they are fulfilling the architectural requirement that the composition pair imposes. Practitioners who do not build it have foreclosed the possibility of governed rapid FAI events and must either accept compliance latency or accept non-compliance. Time pressure is not an exception to the floor; it is an additional reason to invest in pre-authorization infrastructure in advance.

The implication is operational: organizations deploying CKS architecture at inter-Self scope should treat pre-authorization of standing configurations and orchestration rules as a routine governance activity, not as a response to anticipated urgency. The infrastructure is needed before the urgency arises; it cannot be built during it.

Non-Obvious Requirement 3 — Floor as Rapid Maximum

For time-sensitive FAI events, the floor is not merely the minimum governance that must be applied — it is also the maximum governance that can realistically be applied given compressed time. An event that must begin within hours can execute whatever governance is already in place in the standing configuration; it cannot execute governance requirements that were not pre-authorized. Governance requirements above the floor, encoded in the standing configuration, become execution overhead for every urgent event that activates that configuration — including urgent events that need only the floor.

This means governance practitioners should calibrate standing configurations intended for time-sensitive activation to satisfy the floor precisely. Over-engineering the standing configuration — adding governance dimensions, approval layers, or configuration requirements beyond the seven floor elements — creates overhead that time-sensitive events cannot absorb and do not require. The governance practitioner’s discipline for urgent standing configurations is calibration to the floor, not maximization of governance coverage. Events with sufficient preparation time can exceed the floor; events without that time are bounded by what was pre-authorized, and standing configurations calibrated to the floor are the appropriate instrument.

This requirement does not prohibit more elaborate standing configurations for non-urgent contexts. It specifies that standing configurations designated for time-sensitive activation should be designed to floor specification, treating the floor as both lower and upper bound for that use case.

4. Prior-Art Significance

An adversarial position in the intellectual-property or competitive landscape might claim that “governed rapid AI coordination” is a novel development — that rapid AI coordination necessarily compromises governance, or that the combination of speed and compliance at the inter-Self perimeter was not anticipated by prior architectural work. Composition Pair 1 forecloses this claim.

The architecture anticipated the apparent tension between speed and compliance and provided the resolving mechanism — pre-authorization — as an explicit architectural element. D2.21’s standing configurations and D2.41’s time-sensitive governance mechanisms exist precisely because the architecture recognized that operational needs do not always accommodate preparation time. The seven-requirement floor of D2.37 was designed with temporal flexibility in its satisfaction conditions: requirements satisfied before the event are architecturally equivalent to requirements satisfied at the event’s initiation. The combination is not novel; it is the expected operating mode for CKS deployments at inter-Self scope facing operational urgency.

Any claim that rapid governed FAI coordination is novel must contend with this prior-art record: the architecture not only anticipated the combination but specified the preconditions — pre-authorization infrastructure, standing configurations, pre-authorized orchestration rules — that make it achievable. The claim that governance and speed are in irreducible tension at the inter-Self perimeter is directly contradicted by the composition pair’s resolution.

5. Operational Test for the Combined Requirements

For a time-sensitive FAI event, an observer can verify whether Composition Pair 1’s requirements are satisfied by checking the following conditions:

Condition A — Floor satisfaction from pre-authorized infrastructure. All seven minimum viable governance floor requirements are satisfied at the moment the event begins:

1. A standing configuration exists and was authored before the event was initiated.

2. The standing configuration was jointly authorized by the governance structures of the participating entities before the event was initiated.
3. Sharing scope is specified in the standing configuration.
4. Human-authored orchestration rules covering conflict handling at the inter-Self perimeter are encoded in the standing configuration or are otherwise pre-authorized.
5. A persistence policy is specified in the standing configuration.
6. The shared substrate constructed for the event is subject to auditability by inheritance from the CKS substrate-content commitments.
7. Human authority — the rights to inspect, modify, and override — is architecturally available throughout the event.

Condition B — No real-time per-event governance authoring. The event proceeded without any governance authoring, joint authorization, or orchestration rule composition occurring after the decision to initiate the event was made. All governance elements satisfying Condition A were in place before that decision.

If Condition A and Condition B are both true, the composition pair requirements are satisfied. If Condition A is true but Condition B is false, the event was governed but not time-sensitive within the CKS architecture — it was a routine event with available preparation time. If Condition B is true but Condition A is false, the event was rapid but not governed — it proceeded without satisfying the minimum viable governance floor. If both conditions are false, neither commitment is satisfied.

The test is observable: it requires only inspection of the standing configuration's authorization timestamp relative to the event initiation timestamp, and verification that all seven floor elements are present in the pre-authorized infrastructure. No inference about intent or process is required.

6. Conclusion

The composition of the Minimum Viable Governance Floor (D2.37) and Time-Sensitive Governance (D2.41) produces requirements that neither commitment generates individually. The apparent tension between floor compliance and rapid execution is fully resolved by pre-authorization: floor requirements satisfied before the event begins are architecturally equivalent to floor requirements satisfied at initiation. Three non-obvious requirements follow: pre-authorization is a mandatory precondition for the composition pair (not an optimization); the floor is the maximum governance a time-sensitive event can realistically absorb (not merely the minimum); and the architecture anticipated and resolved the apparent speed-compliance tension, foreclosing claims that governed rapid FAI coordination is novel. Practitioners operating CKS architecture at inter-Self scope should treat standing governance infrastructure as routine preparation, not contingency planning — the infrastructure must exist before urgency arises,

because it cannot be built during it.

Source papers

Li, W. (2026). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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